

AMC PATHWAY , NEWEST ROUTE

The Expedited Specialist pathway

Last verified 2026-06-15. A guide from IMG Pathways Australia.

BEST FOR	Specialists whose qualification is on the Board's accepted list
LEADS TO	Specialist registration
WHAT IS INVOLVED	No comparability assessment, six months supervised practice

The Expedited Specialist pathway is the newest and fastest route to specialist registration. It's for specialist international medical graduates (SIMGs) whose qualification is on the Medical Board's Expedited Specialist pathway: accepted qualifications list. If your exact qualification is listed, you skip the college comparability assessment and don't join a college training program. This pathway is changing fast, check the date on this page and confirm the current specialty list with the Board before relying on it.

What makes it 'expedited'

On the usual Specialist pathway, an Australian specialist college assesses how comparable your training is, which takes time and money. The Expedited Specialist pathway removes that step for eligible specialists: no comparability assessment and no college training program. It was introduced following the independent (Kruk) review of regulatory settings to help suitably qualified specialists register faster.

Which specialties are included

Specialties are added to the accepted-qualifications list over time. As of the verify date on this page, accepted qualifications exist for:

- General practice
- Anaesthesia
- Obstetrics and gynaecology
- Psychiatry
- General medicine (added 19 January 2026)
- General paediatrics (added 19 January 2026)

Diagnostic radiology was being assessed for inclusion at the time of writing. Because the list grows, always confirm the current list and your exact qualification on the Board's page before acting.

What you still need to do

Skipping the comparability assessment doesn't mean skipping oversight. On this pathway you still complete:

- 6 months of supervised practice
- Cultural safety education
- Orientation to the Australian health system
- Workplace-based assessments

You'll hold limited or provisional registration during this period before specialist registration is granted.

Am I eligible?

Eligibility turns on whether your specific specialist qualification (from a specific country/college) appears on the accepted-qualifications list, not just your specialty. The finder can suggest whether this pathway is worth investigating, but only the Board's list and your application confirm it. If your qualification isn't listed, the standard Specialist pathway applies.

English, visas and registration

You must still meet the English language requirement (see English requirements). Roles are typically employer-sponsored, often via the Skills in Demand (subclass 482) visa. Migration is regulated, confirm with a registered MARA agent. The pathway leads to specialist registration with the Medical Board.

Frequently asked questions

Is the expedited pathway open to my specialty?

Only the specialties with accepted qualifications are eligible (general practice, anaesthesia, O&G, psychiatry, and from January 2026 general medicine and general paediatrics). The list is expanding, so check the Board's current page.

Does being in an eligible specialty guarantee I qualify?

No. Your specific qualification (country and college) must be on the accepted-qualifications list. If it isn't, you'd use the standard Specialist pathway.

Is it really faster?

It removes the college comparability assessment and training-program step, which are usually the slowest parts. You still complete 6 months of supervised practice and assessments.

Sources and last verified

1. Medical Board of Australia: Expedited Specialist pathway (verified 2026-06-15)
2. AHPRA: Fast track registration pathway expanded (verified 2026-06-15)
3. AHPRA: Expedited Specialist pathway now open to two new specialties (verified 2026-06-15)
4. Medical Board of Australia: English language skills registration standard (verified 2026-06-15)
5. Department of Home Affairs: Skills in Demand visa (subclass 482) (verified 2026-06-15)